

Kevin Buckley, PMP

Technology Portfolio Operations Director | IT Portfolio & Program Leadership

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Summary

Senior technology and portfolio executive with 15+ years leading technically complex software, cloud, and enterprise application portfolios and Technical Program Management functions. Proven record establishing portfolio management discipline, governance frameworks, Agile/SAFe delivery cadences, reporting rhythms, and data-driven decision support to improve release readiness and reduce execution risk. Experienced with systems engineering and software development lifecycles in matrixed, mission-driven environments; skilled at developing TPMs, influencing senior leaders, and aligning strategy, investment, and talent. PMP- and SAFe-certified leader known for building high-performing teams and maturing delivery operations.

Work

Information Technology Portfolio Manager

2025 - Present

USDA FPAC Business Center | Lake Elsinore, CA

- Built and implemented a sustainable portfolio management framework that standardized governance, quality assurance, release management, infrastructure migration planning, portfolio reporting cadences, and executive decision support—enabling consistent technical program management across teams.
- Partnered with the Software Delivery Chief, CTO, product owners, and DevOps to align technology execution with mission priorities, resource constraints, delivery risks, and portfolio objectives, including alignment to organizational OKRs and finance inputs.
- Improved portfolio efficiency by 40% by maturing operating cadence, governance controls, delivery accountability, and cross-functional coordination across application teams, ensuring consistent software engineering and software architecture implementation.
- Developed a product valuation process using Lean Portfolio Management principles and actual data points to improve portfolio ranking and goal-setting strategies.
- Drove adoption of portfolio management practices among peer IT portfolio managers, improving consistency, transparency, and delivery discipline across the organization.

Acting ISD Conservation Section Chief

2024 - 2025

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- Directed operational oversight across five Agile software development and support services teams, maintaining continuity and stability for 50+ enterprise software solutions, including COTS and custom applications.
- Led through influence across eight teams comprising federal employees and 700+ contractors, strengthening engagement, accountability, and delivery coordination during leadership transition.
- Implemented SAFe-based planning practices and change-management communications to create a three-month roadmap containing 200+ planned objectives and 300+ planned features, improving delivery cadence and stakeholder visibility.
- Improved organizational readiness by clarifying priorities, stabilizing delivery cadence, and enhancing communication across federal and contractor teams, enabling the success of dozens of technical projects.

Government Program Manager

2023 - 2025

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- Directed a \$38M Agile software development program while maturing enterprise delivery, increasing stakeholder confidence, and elevating program performance across the portfolio.
- Developed a data-driven Program QA Plan with 20+ quality metrics, reducing software defects and improving program quality by 30% while increasing transparency into release readiness and delivery risk through analytics-driven reporting.

- Led a 98-member organization across eight development teams, two shared services teams, and one leadership team; achieved 100% adherence to SAFe best practices in contract execution.

Director of Technology Products and Services

2020 - 2023

211 San Diego | San Diego, CA

- Managed a broad portfolio of strategic initiatives across client/affiliate support, call center operations, technology operations, and product enhancement—improving delivery discipline and stakeholder satisfaction while providing consulting support to partner agencies.
- Overhauled project management processes and applied automation and workflow technologies to complete 31 projects on time and on budget in a single year, improving execution discipline and internal communication.

Director of Innovation and Technology

2015 - 2020

Disability Insurance Services | San Diego, CA

- Improved operational efficiency by 50% by optimizing information system utilization, modernizing processes, and improving technology enablement across the enterprise.
- Migrated a proprietary sales CRM supporting \$6M in annual sales from on-premises infrastructure to a web-based platform, enabling uninterrupted remote operations during the COVID crisis.
- Built the IT function from a single-person operation into a multi-department, cross-domain team supporting enterprise systems, innovation, service delivery, and business operations.

Education and Certifications

DM Technology Management, Colorado Technical University

MSM IT Management, Colorado Technical University

BS Computer Information Systems, SUNY Institute of Technology

Project Management Professional (PMP), Project Management Institute

Certified SAFe 6 Agilist, Scaled Agile, Inc.

Clearance

TS/SCI Clearance, 1977-2009; 2009-2025

Skills

Technical Program & Portfolio Leadership

Technical Program Management, IT Portfolio Management, Enterprise Planning, OKRs, Strategic Roadmaps, Operating Cadence, Governance Frameworks, Executive Reporting, Cross-Functional Program Delivery, Technical Architecture, Systems Engineering

Agile & Software Delivery

SAFe, Agile Program Management, Release Management, Software Development Lifecycle, Quality Assurance, DevOps Coordination, Cloud Infrastructure, AWS, GCP

Transformation & Operations

Change Management, Process Improvement, Resource Optimization, Vendor Management, Contract Portfolio Oversight, Risk Management, Delivery Maturity, Analytics, RFP

Executive Leadership

Stakeholder Management, Product/Engineering Alignment, Team Building, Talent Development, Leadership Development, Communication Strategy, Business-Technology Alignment, Data-Driven Decision Support